

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Shoaib Arshad

Address: 3 Lymbourne Close Belmont SM2 6DX

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to express my full support for the planning application to convert the former ambulance centre in Belmont into a community space for prayers and meetings.

This facility is genuinely needed within the local community. The Muslim community in Belmont has grown over the years, yet there is currently no suitable, purpose-built space to accommodate prayers and community gatherings. At present, members meet in limited space at St John Hall, which is not designed for this purpose and does not adequately serve the needs of a progressive and growing community.

The building has been unused for some time. Its conversion into a community space represents a positive and constructive use of an otherwise dormant site. It would be far more beneficial for the area to have a managed, community-led facility than to see the site sold for high-density residential development, which could create significantly greater and more permanent traffic and parking pressures.

Concerns have been raised regarding traffic, parking and safety, particularly given the nearby primary school. These matters can be managed through appropriate planning conditions, clear parking guidance and responsible stewardship by the community. Prayer times are structured and predictable, and peak usage would not coincide with school drop-off and pick-up times on most weekdays. A community facility of this nature is unlikely to generate the same continuous daily traffic as alternative commercial or residential developments.

Importantly, this project promotes inclusion, cohesion and collaboration within Belmont. Providing

a safe and dedicated space for community gathering strengthens social responsibility and encourages constructive engagement with the wider neighbourhood. Rejecting such an application risks creating unnecessary division rather than fostering mutual understanding.

I respectfully urge the planning authority to consider the long-term social benefit this facility will bring and to approve the application.